

Tree Species

- proposed_plants

Utah State Capitol Perimeter Trees

Location: 350 N State St, Salt Lake City, Salt Lake County, UT | **USDA Zone:** 6b

Summary

Uniform perimeter planting of 316 drought-resistant native trees at 5-metre spacing around the Capitol grounds boundary.

Selected Species

- **Rocky Mountain Juniper** (*Juniperus scopulorum*) × 316 — City side

Benefits

- Utah native — no irrigation after establishment (year 2+)
- Columnar evergreen; formal year-round structure
- Zones 3–7; tolerates alkaline compacted soils and reflected heat
- High transplanting success rate

Budget Estimate

Prices: Utah Plants nursery, Oct 2026.

Item	Scientific	Side	Size	Qty	Unit $	Total
Rocky Mountain Juniper	*Juniperus scopulorum*	City	5-gal	316	$50	$15,800
Plants Subtotal (316)						**$15,800**

Materials

Item	Qty	Unit	Unit $	Total
Bark mulch (3 in depth)	3	cu yd	$30.00	$90
Compost / soil amendment	2	cu yd	$22.00	$44
Drip emitters + tubing	1	set	$120.00	$120
Plant stakes, flags, labels	1	set	$30.00	$30
Materials Subtotal				**$284**
Sales Tax (8.7%)				$1,399
GRAND TOTAL				**$17,483**

Plant Visualization

Photo	Common / Scientific	Form	Height	Width	Growth	Seasonal
	**Rocky Mountain Juniper** *Juniperus scopulorum*	Columnar to narrowly pyramidal	30–40 ft	3–15 ft	Slow	Silver-blue berry-like cones persist through winter; blue-green evergreen foliage year-round

Planting Instructions

When to Plant

- **Best: Sep 15 – Oct 31** — roots establish before freeze
- Second best: Mar 15 – Apr 30
- Avoid Jun–Aug and frozen ground

Hole Preparation

- Dig 2–3× wider than root ball, same depth as container
- Backfill with native soil only

Mulching

- 3 in bark mulch; keep 2 in clear of trunk

Species Notes

Rocky Mountain Juniper

Plant in well-drained soil in full sun. Water deeply 2x/week for first month, then weekly through year 1. Mulch 3 in around base keeping mulch away from trunk. No supplemental irrigation needed after year 2.

Horticultural Specifications

USDA Zone 6b. Utah native.

Common	Scientific	H	W	Water	Sun	Zone	Root	Soil
Rocky Mountain Juniper	*Juniperus scopulorum*	30–40 ft	3–15 ft	Very Low	Full	3–7	Fibrous; non-invasive; no suckering	Sandy to clay loam; well-drained; tolerates alkaline soils